

词汇: *biology* 生物学

- 1 It's a topic people usually avoid, yet it's a universal human experience. Flatulence, affectionately known as farting, is simply the releasing of gas from the backside. The word itself traces back to the Latin 'flatus', which literally means 'a blowing' or 'wind.' While it is often **the butt of the joke**, we do it for very practical reasons, which **boil down to** digestion. Most mammals have a complex, **symbiotic** relationship with their gut **microbes** which break down food. Digestion requires a lengthy process of **fermentation**, and flatulence is simply the **inevitable byproduct** of these hard-working bacteria. Passing gas is a sign of a highly functioning digestive system.
- 2 But we humans aren't the only mammals that like to **let one off**. In 2017, National Geographic and the BBC reported the results of an online survey. It revealed some incredibly unlikely farters, like zebras, which have been documented farting with every single step whilst running away from predators. On a bigger scale, cow flatulence and burps are packed with methane, a **potent greenhouse gas** that is actively driving global climate change. And, if you've ever had a **domesticated** pet, you might've even **blamed** your own farts on them! I know I have.
- 3 There are other fascinating examples of farting from the **animal kingdom**. The Sonoran coral snake **expels** air forcefully to **startle** predators when it's in danger. In an article published on The Conversation, it's mentioned that herring, a type of fish, will release gas as a way to communicate with each other that predators are nearby. It was also written in IFLScience that the beaded lacewing, a type of larva, can **take down** six termites with one fart!
- 4 So it seems that some animals pass gas as an evolutionary survival **tactic**. Those not so '**silent but deadly**' farts can **ward off** predators as well as let others know that there's potential danger. While farts for us are mainly the result of digestion, perhaps, like the Sonoran snake, herring and beaded lacewing, we could **embrace** the breeze and **utilise** them against our enemies? Hahaha, just joking!

测验与练习

一、为本文选择总结句。

- a. Animals farting is a major problem.
- b. Farting is natural – a lot of animals fart.
- c. Most mammals fart when they're in danger.

二、根据文章内容选出正确的选项。

1. Passing gas is a sign that there is an issue or malfunction in a person's digestive system.
 - a. True
 - b. False
 - c. Not given
2. According to the text, why do Sonoran coral snakes expel air forcefully?
 - a. They do it as a response to running away from predators.
 - b. They do it to communicate with others that there are predators nearby.
 - c. They do it to startle chasing predators.
3. Methane is a type of gas that...
 - a. accelerates climate change.
 - b. helps slow down climate change.
 - c. makes a cow's gut healthier.
4. The gas released by herring contains toxic chemicals.
 - a. True
 - b. False
 - c. Not given
5. The beaded lacewing larva can kill up to six termites at a time with a single fart.
 - a. True
 - b. False
 - c. Not given

三、用方框中的单词完成对本文的总结。

For most animals, farts are a natural **1)** _____ of **2)** _____ in the digestive system. But for some animals, they are used as a **3)** _____ when they feel they're in danger. They **4)** _____ either to communicate with others about predators, or to **5)** _____ predators, giving them a chance to escape!

startle	let one off	greenhouse gas
blame		byproduct
fermentation		tactic

（答案见词汇表后）

词汇表

the butt of the joke	被取笑的对象
boil down to	归结为
symbiotic	共生的
microbe	微生物
fermentation	发酵
inevitable	无法避免的
byproduct	副产物
let one off	（无意中）放屁（委婉说法）
potent	强效的，效果明显的
greenhouse gas	温室气体
domesticated	家养的
blame	责怪，责备
animal kingdom	动物界
expel	排出
startle	使...受惊吓
take down	消灭，击倒
tactic	策略，手段
silent but deadly	无声但杀伤力十足
ward off	抵挡，驱离
embrace	欣然接受
utilise	有效利用

答案

一、为本文选择总结句。

b. Farting is natural – a lot of animals fart.

二、根据文章内容选出正确的选项。

1. **b. False.** *Passing gas is a sign of **a highly functioning digestive system**.*
2. **c.** *The Sonoran coral snake expels air forcefully to **startle predators when it's in danger**.*
3. **a.** *On a bigger scale, cow flatulence and burps are packed with methane, a potent greenhouse gas that is **actively driving global climate change**.*
4. **c. Not given.** While the text confirms that herring use flatulence to communicate about nearby predators, it does not mention what kind of chemicals that the gas contains.
5. **a. True.** *...beaded lacwing, a type of larva, **can take down six termites with one fart!***

三、用方框中的单词完成对本文的总结。

For most animals, farts are a natural **byproduct** of **fermentation** in the digestive system. But for some animals, they are used as a **tactic** when they feel they're in danger. They **let one off** either to communicate with others about predators, or to **startle** predators, giving them a chance to escape!